

Five minutes to a calmer dissertation.

One workbook, seven connected sheets. Start in the tool you already use — everything below takes less time than making coffee.

Microsoft Excel (recommended)

1. Unzip nothing — just double-click `PhD-Research-OS.xlsx`.
2. If Excel shows a yellow "Protected View" bar, click **Enable Editing** (the file comes from a download, that's all).
3. Read the **Start Here** tab (60 seconds), then add your first source in **Literature**.

Google Sheets

1. Go to `sheets.google.com` and open a blank spreadsheet.
2. Menu **File** → **Import** → **Upload**, choose `PhD-Research-OS.xlsx`.
3. Pick **"Replace spreadsheet"** and confirm. Formulas, dropdowns and colors survive the trip.
4. Rename the file (e.g. "PhD Research OS") — done.

LibreOffice & Apple Numbers

LibreOffice Calc opens the file out of the box. Apple Numbers works too — minor visual differences (colors, column widths) are possible. For the smoothest experience we recommend Excel or Google Sheets.

Three habits that make it work

① One row per source, the moment you find it. ② Ten honest minutes every Friday in **Weekly**. ③ Agenda into **Meetings** *before* you see your supervisor.

Good to know

- The **Dashboard** computes itself — never type there (it's protected against accidents; you can unprotect it anytime).
- The **AI Prompts** sheet: copy a prompt, fill the [brackets], paste into ChatGPT, Claude or any assistant. The thinking stays yours.
- Duplicate the file per project. Archive, don't delete — your Literature tab becomes your citation memory.
- **Something broken or confusing?** Message us on Etsy — we answer within 48 hours and fix any formula bug.